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# CASE STUDY

## SKYFRAME

VERSION 1.0 / 2025

# TABLE OF CONTENTS

|                               |    |                                |    |
|-------------------------------|----|--------------------------------|----|
| 1. Overview .....             | 1  | 5. Journey Map .....           | 21 |
| 2. Problem & Goals .....      | 3  | 6. IA & User Flows .....       | 23 |
| • Background .....            | 3  | • Sitemap .....                | 23 |
| • Problem Statement .....     | 5  | • Key User Flows .....         | 24 |
| • Design Goal .....           | 7  | 7. Wireframes .....            | 26 |
| • Success Metrics (KPI) ..... | 9  | 8. Design System .....         | 28 |
| 3. Competitive Analysis.....  | 11 | • Foundation .....             | 28 |
| • Comparison Matrix .....     | 11 | • Components .....             | 30 |
| • Key Insights .....          | 12 | 9. High-Fidelity Mockups ..... | 31 |
| • SkyFrame Positioning .....  | 15 | 10. Prototype .....            | 33 |
| 4. User Research .....        | 16 |                                |    |
| • Target Audience .....       | 16 |                                |    |
| • Persona .....               | 17 |                                |    |
| • User Scenario.....          | 19 |                                |    |

## Project

SkyFrame is a mobile app designed for the Bluesky ecosystem, offering an image-focused feed viewing experience.

## Background

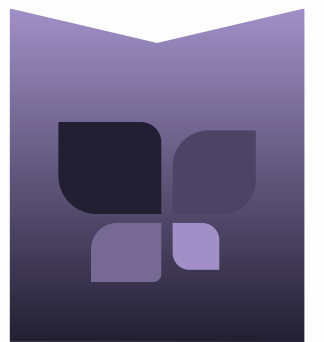
- Bluesky's feed mixes text and image posts, making it difficult for visual creators to maintain visibility.
- Each user's Media Tab is separated, forcing viewers to visit multiple profiles individually and preventing a unified visual exploration experience.

## Solution

SkyFrame utilizes the Bluesky AT Protocol to filter and consolidate image posts into a single, unified visual feed.

## Core Features

- Unified image-only feed (Discover & Following)
- Masonry layout for natural visual rhythm
- Quick like and save interactions
- Collection-based curation (Phase 2)

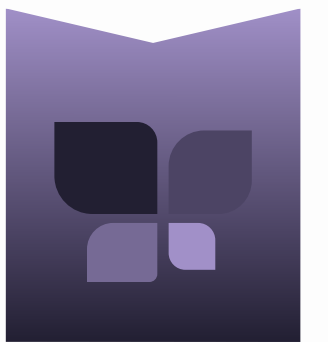


## Scope

- Phase 1 (MVP): Authentication, feed, search, local like/save, profile
- Phase 2: Post creation, server sync, collection management
- Phase 3: Portfolio mode, external sharing

## Success Metrics

- 10–20 beta testers
- Average session duration 5 min +
- User satisfaction 4.0 / 5.0 +
- App stability 95 % + (crash-free rate)





## Background

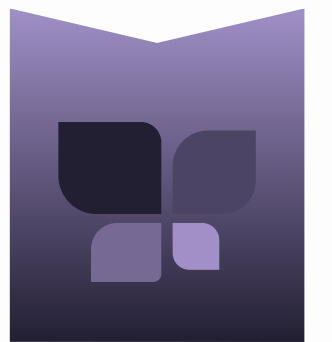
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### Background

- Bluesky is a decentralized social networking platform built on the AT Protocol.
- It offers a light and user-centered social experience rather than one driven by algorithms.
- Within this environment, a creative community of illustrators and designers has formed.
- Many artists who moved from Twitter now use Bluesky as a space to share sketches and works in progress, turning it into a casual and creative hub for visual expression.

### Current Situation

- The official Bluesky app presents a mixed timeline of text and image posts.
- Each user profile includes a Media tab, but these are separated for every account.
- To explore artworks from multiple followed artists, users must visit each profile individually.
- This repetitive navigation makes the process of visual exploration inefficient and fragmented.



# PROBLEM & GOALS

## Background

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### Observed User Behavior

Users who focus mainly on visual content tend to follow a similar pattern:

- Scroll through the main feed and notice an artist's post
- Move to the artist's profile
- Open the Media tab to view only image posts
- Return to the feed and repeat with another artist

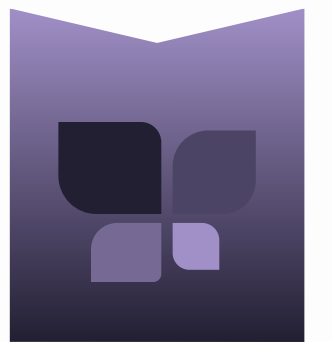
This sequence often continues ten to fifteen times and creates significant friction for users who simply want to browse visual inspiration.

### Limitations of Existing Platforms

- Pinterest provides strong discovery features but is heavily centered on curated and polished content, making it difficult to find the spontaneous sketches and process-based works that Bluesky users enjoy.
- Instagram focuses on images but relies on algorithms and advertisements, which make organic discovery less consistent.

### Need for a Solution

- There is a clear need for an integrated image-only feed within the Bluesky ecosystem. Such a feature would allow creators and viewers to explore visual content more easily while keeping the platform's sense of lightness and community.



# PROBLEM & GOALS

## Problem Statement

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### From the Creators' Perspective

Bluesky's text-centered timeline structure reduces the visibility of image content.

Visual works uploaded by creators are quickly pushed down as they mix with text posts.

As a result, many creators feel that their artwork is not properly exposed or appreciated.

#### Key Issues

- Image posts are quickly buried within the text feed
- No dedicated space for showcasing visual works
- Lack of an optimized experience for sharing sketches or works in progress

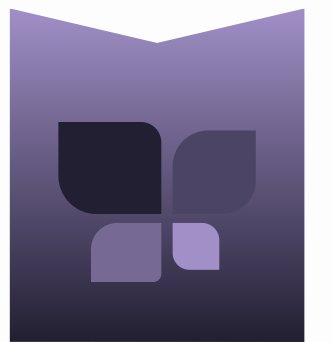
### From the Viewers' Perspective

Users who seek visual inspiration have no efficient way to view artworks from multiple followed artists in one place.

Each artist's Media tab is isolated within their profile, requiring users to repeat the same navigation steps across accounts.

#### Key Issues

- Must visit each artist's profile individually to view images
- Difficult to find visual content within a mixed text feed
- User experience not optimized for visual browsing, causing cognitive fatigue



# PROBLEM & GOALS

## Problem Statement

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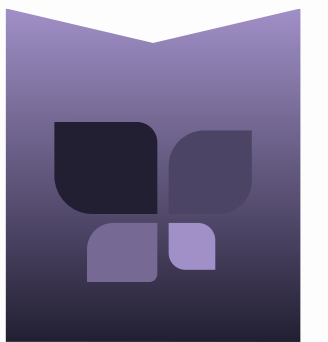
### From the Platform's Perspective

Although Bluesky's visual creator community continues to grow, features for image discovery remain limited.

The official app is still designed primarily for text-based interaction, making visual content harder to discover and consume effectively.

#### Key Issues

- No native function for image-only feeds
- Limited mechanisms for visual content discovery
- Insufficient connection experience between creators and viewers



# PROBLEM & GOALS

## Design Goal

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### Main Objective

SkyFrame unifies the scattered Media tabs within Bluesky into a single, consolidated image feed. It aims to provide a distraction-free, image-centered experience for both visual creators and viewers.

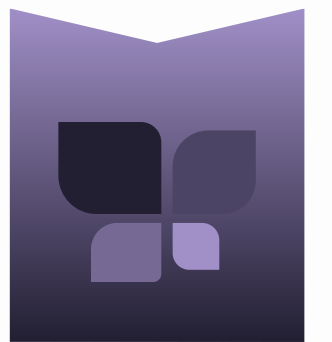
### Specific Goals

#### 1. Provide a Unified Visual Exploration Experience

- Combine image posts from followed artists into one continuous feed
- Automatically filter out text posts for a purely visual environment
- Enable seamless image browsing without switching between profiles

#### 2. Support Efficient Content Discovery

- Introduce a Discover feed to help users find new creators by interest
- Simplify exploration through tag and keyword search
- Use a Masonry layout for natural display of various image ratios





# PROBLEM & GOALS

## Design Goal

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### Specific Goals

#### 3. Offer Fast and Intuitive Curation Tools

- Reduce interaction friction with one-tap like and save actions
- Allow users to organize collected images into themed collections
- Support offline revisits through local caching for faster access

#### 4. Preserve the Identity of the Bluesky Ecosystem

- Maintain a chronological, follow-based feed without algorithms
- Keep the interface light and fast to reflect Bluesky's sense of simplicity
- Ensure full compatibility with the AT Protocol and Bluesky's open structure

### Design Principles

#### Content First

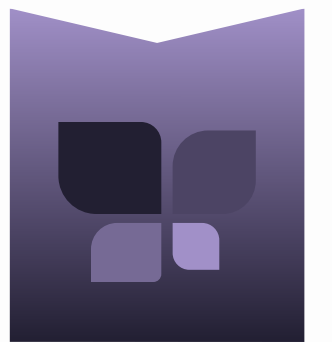
Over 80% of the screen space is dedicated to imagery, with UI elements appearing only when needed.

#### Lightweight

Minimal interface and quick interactions maintain the effortless experience that defines Bluesky.

#### Delightful

Smooth animations and responsive feedback create a sense of enjoyment and flow throughout the experience.



# PROBLEM & GOALS

## Success Metrics (KPI)

| Metric                   | Target              | Measurement Method                          | Priority |
|--------------------------|---------------------|---------------------------------------------|----------|
| Beta Tester Recruitment  | 10–20 users         | Invite link shared within Bluesky community | High     |
| Average Session Duration | 5 minutes or longer | App analytics                               | High     |
| Save Rate                | 30% or higher       | Number of saves per total post views        | Medium   |
| App Stability            | 95% or higher       | Crash-free rate (Crashlytics)               | High     |
| User Satisfaction        | 4.0 / 5.0 or higher | Beta tester survey (NPS)                    | High     |

## Phase 1 (MVP) Goals

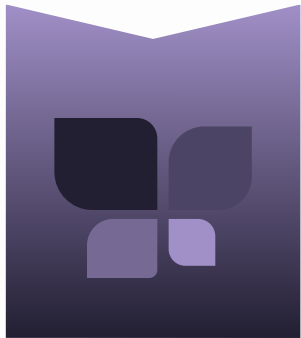
### Qualitative Success Indicators

#### User Feedback Goals

- It’s much easier to explore images now.
- I no longer need to visit multiple profiles.
- I find myself using Bluesky more often.

#### Behavioral Indicators

- Visit frequency of at least three times per week
- Viewing more than ten posts per session
- Active use of the collection feature (Phase 2)



# PROBLEM & GOALS

## Success Metrics (KPI)

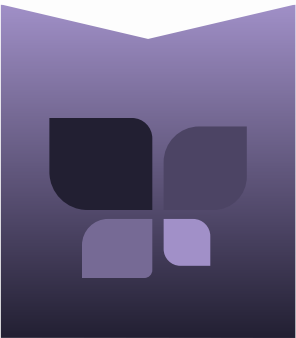
| Metric                   | Target        | Measurement Method          |
|--------------------------|---------------|-----------------------------|
| Daily Active Users (DAU) | 50 or more    | App analytics               |
| Post Creation Rate       | 20% or higher | Creator participation ratio |
| Collection Creation Rate | 40% or higher | Curation engagement rate    |
| 7-Day Retention          | 50% or higher | Revisit rate                |

## Phase 2 Expansion Metrics

### Failure Criteria

Phase 2 progression will be reevaluated if two or more of the following conditions are met:

- Fewer than 10 beta testers
- Average session duration under 3 minutes
- User satisfaction below 3.0 / 5.0
- Crash rate above 10%

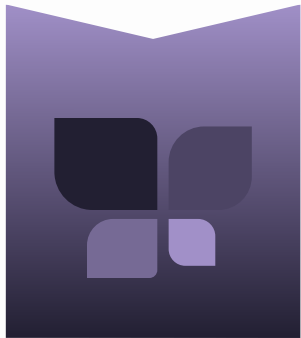




# COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

## Comparison Matrix

| Platform               | Strengths                                       | Weaknesses                                                    |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bluesky (Official App) | Clean interface, fast performance               | Limited image discovery<br>(Media tabs are separated by user) |
| Instagram              | Large user base, strong focus on visual content | Algorithmic clutter, excessive ads, text noise                |
| Pinterest              | Powerful discovery features                     | Over-personalized algorithm, unclear creator attribution      |
| ArtStation             | Professional-grade portfolios                   | Heavy UX, intimidating for casual creators                    |
| Pixiv                  | Active artist community                         | Japan-centric, semi-closed ecosystem                          |



# COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

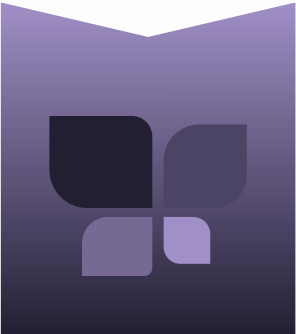
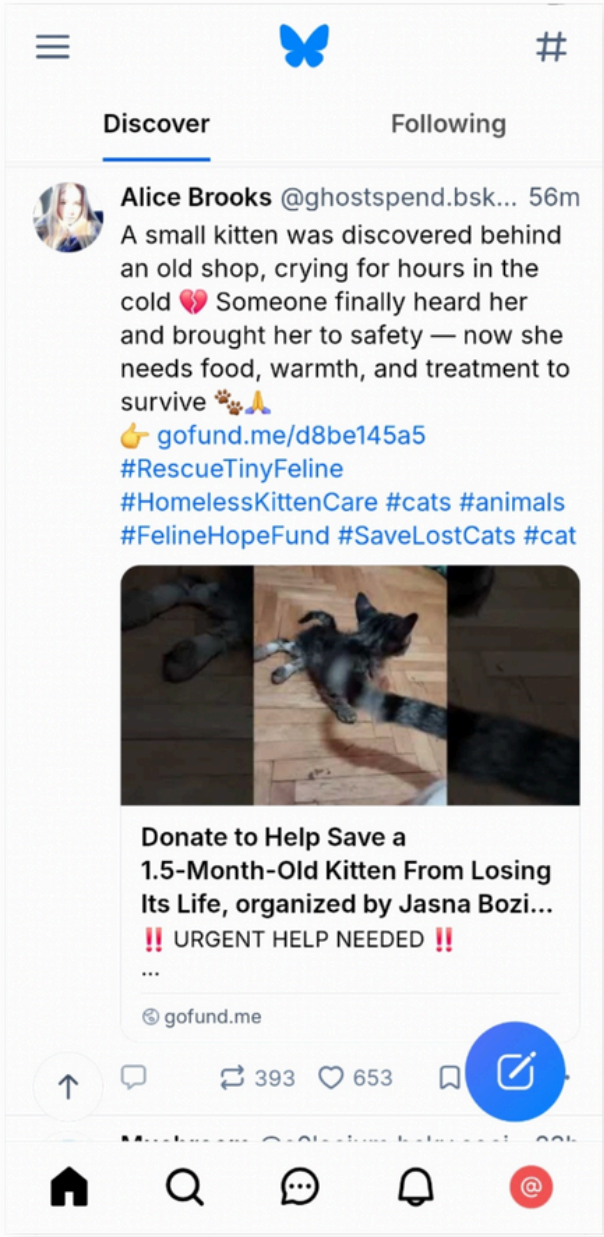
## Key Insights



### Key Insights

#### Bluesky

While the platform’s lightweight, algorithm-free experience is appealing, its Media tabs are separated per user, preventing integrated image exploration.



# COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

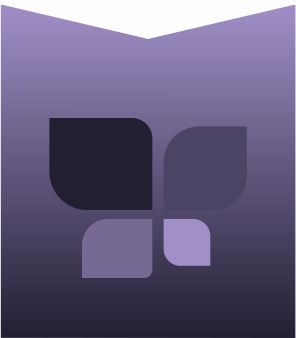
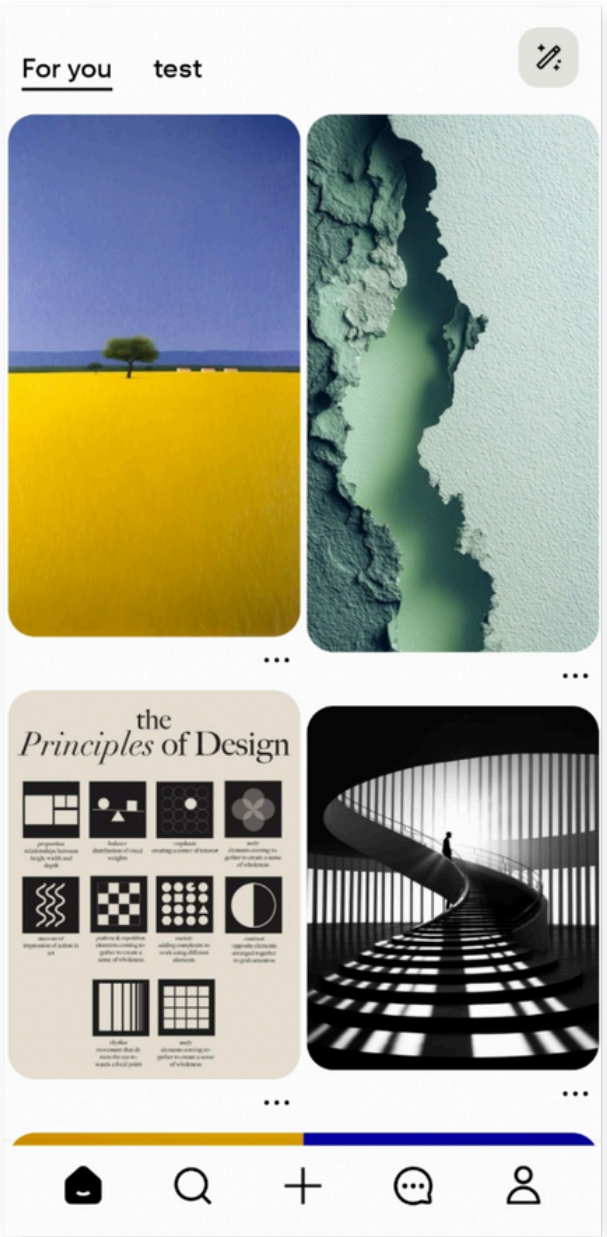
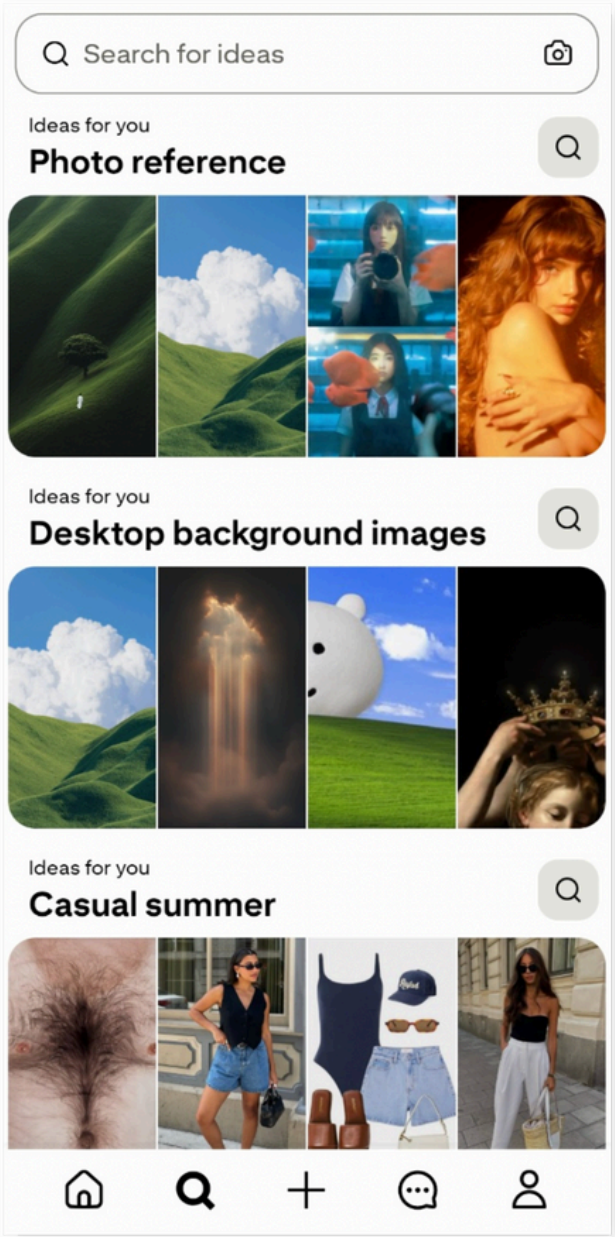
## Key Insights



### Key Insights

#### Pinterest

Its Masonry layout and curated boards offer a polished visual experience, but over-personalization limits organic discovery.





# COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

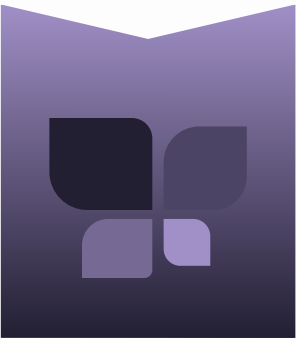
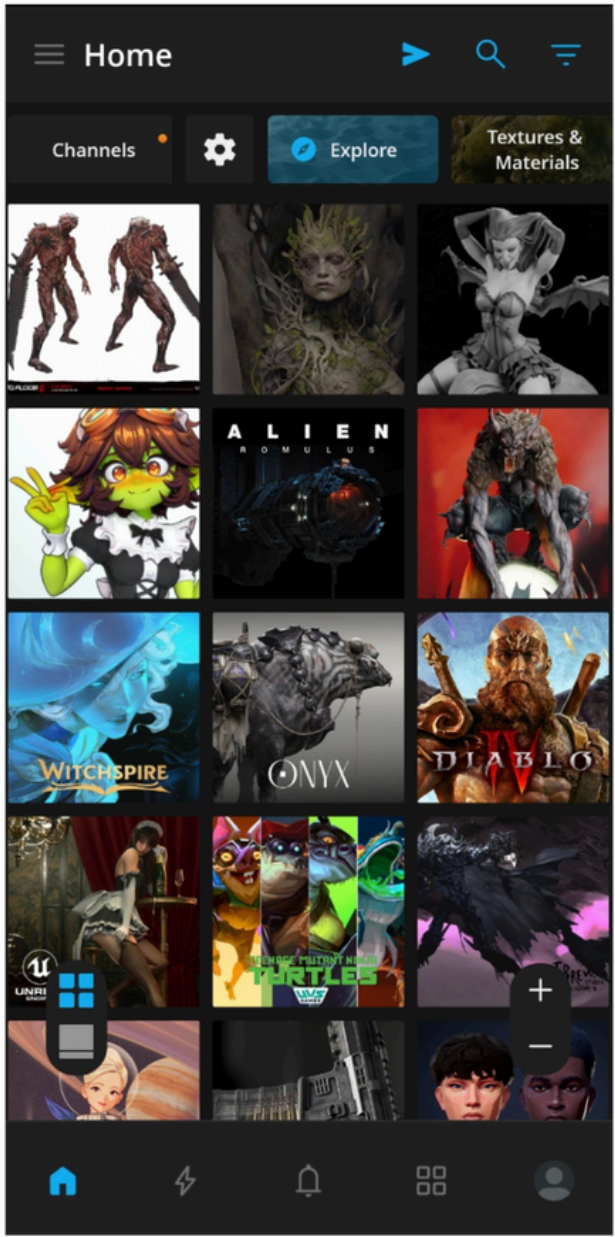
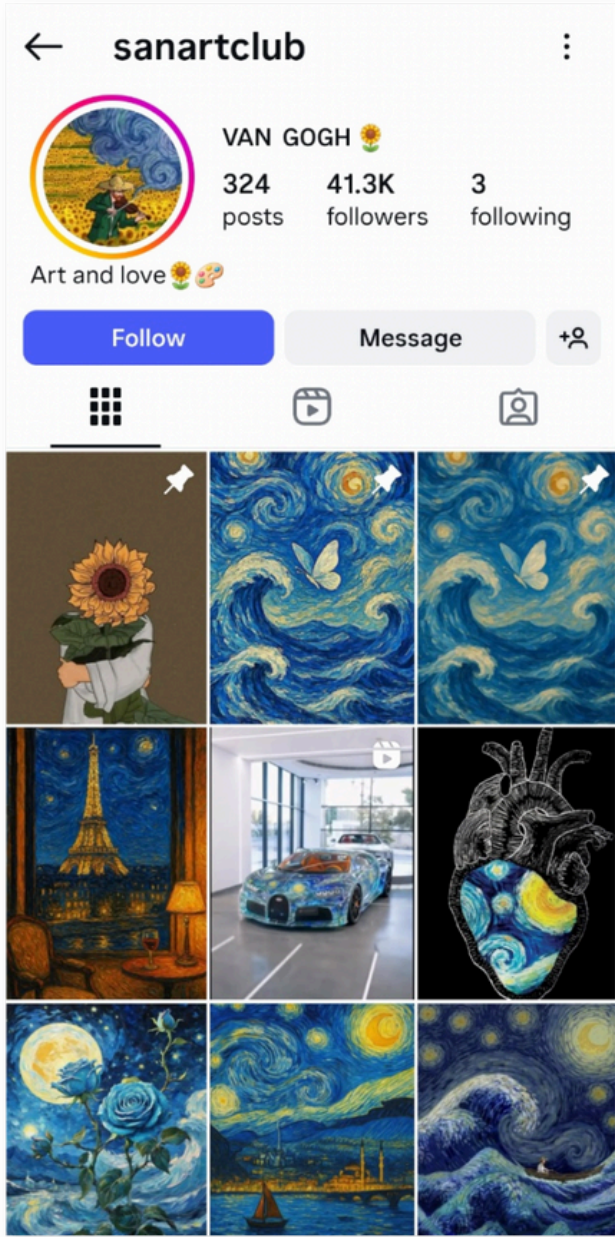
## Key Insights



### Key Insights

#### Instagram / Professional Platforms

These platforms have large user bases, but suffer from algorithm fatigue (Instagram) or high entry barriers for casual creators (ArtStation, Pixiv).



# COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

## SkyFrame Positioning

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### Core Positioning

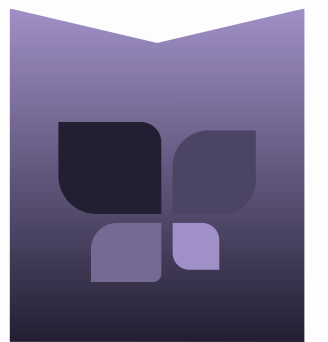
An image-focused feed that combines the spontaneity of Bluesky with the curation strength of Pinterest.

### Target Users

- Visual content consumers within the active Bluesky community
- Users experiencing algorithm fatigue on platforms like Pinterest
- Independent creators who enjoy sharing sketches or works in progress (WIP)

### Differentiation Strategy

- Unified Image Feed: Consolidates image posts from followed artists into one continuous feed
- Pure Visual Experience: Filters out text to create an immersive, image-only environment
- No Algorithms: Chronological, follow-based feed with tag-based search
- Lightweight UX: Maintains Bluesky's sense of simplicity and speed



## Target Audience

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### Primary User Groups



#### Creators

Illustrators and designers who share sketches or works in progress (WIPs)



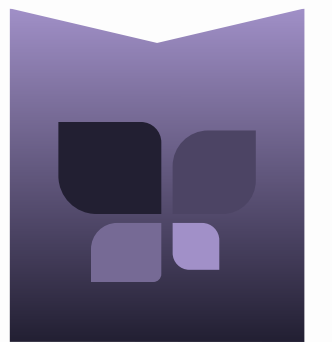
#### Viewers

Design students and art enthusiasts seeking visual inspiration

SkyFrame targets users within the Bluesky ecosystem who are primarily focused on visual content.

### User Characteristics

- Age Range: Late teens to 40s (core group: 20s–30s)
- Platform Usage: Mobile-first, visual content-oriented consumption habits
- Needs: Fast image browsing and an authentic, algorithm-free feed experience



## Persona / Creator



Minji Kim

|                |                         |
|----------------|-------------------------|
| Age            | 23                      |
| Education      | Self-taught Illustrator |
| Occupation     | Freelance Illustrator   |
| Location       | Seoul, South Korea      |
| Tech Savviness | High                    |

“ I wish my drawings wouldn’t disappear so quickly, I just want them to be seen.

### Bio

Minji is a freelance illustrator based in Seoul. Self-taught, she shares everyday character sketches and works in progress on Bluesky. She prefers posting casual drawings and process shots rather than polished portfolio pieces. However, she often feels frustrated that her images quickly get buried in Bluesky’s text-heavy feed.

### Goals

- Find a space where her artwork can be displayed visually
- Share sketches and WIPs freely without pressure
- Connect naturally with viewers who appreciate her work

### Behaviors

- Uploads sketches three to five times a week
- Checks other artists’ work while having morning coffee
- Draws on iPad Pro with Procreate and posts directly to Bluesky

### Pain Points

- Image posts get buried quickly under text-based updates
- Media tab is hidden inside the profile, making her work hard to discover
- Instagram feels too algorithmic, and Pinterest is too polished for casual sketches

### Tools & Platforms

- Bluesky
- Instagram



## Persona / Viewers



Junho Park

|                |                      |
|----------------|----------------------|
| Age            | 25                   |
| Education      | Graphic Design Major |
| Occupation     | Design Student       |
| Location       | Vancouver, Canada    |
| Tech Savviness | High                 |

“ I just want to see all the images from the artists I follow in one place, not jump between profiles.

### Bio

Junho is a graphic design student who browses Bluesky daily to find visual inspiration from illustrators and artists. He follows over 50 creators but finds it inconvenient to visit each profile’s Media tab to view their images. Rather than scrolling through text-heavy feeds, he prefers a pure visual browsing experience.

### Goals

- View the latest image posts from followed artists in one unified feed
- Collect and organize visual references quickly
- Discover new creators within his interests

### Behaviors

- Browses Bluesky twice a day, around 15 minutes per session
- Saves favorite images by taking screenshots
- Organizes references on weekends for design projects

### Pain Points

- Has to visit each artist’s profile individually to see their images
- Feels fatigued scrolling through text and image mixed feeds
- Finds Pinterest too algorithm-driven, lacking spontaneous, creator-led content

### Tools & Platforms

- Bluesky
- Pinterest
- Reddit
- Notion



## User Scenario / Creator



**Minji Kim**

|            |                       |
|------------|-----------------------|
| Age        | 23                    |
| Occupation | Freelance Illustrator |
| Location   | Seoul, South Korea    |

### Context: Morning Sketch Routine

On a Tuesday morning in Seoul, Minji wakes up at seven and pours herself a cup of coffee. As she turns on her iPad, last night’s character sketch appears on the screen. She smiles, satisfied with the result, and opens Bluesky.

“It is not perfect,” she thinks, “but I like sharing these small morning sketches.” Instagram feels too polished, and Pinterest seems made for finished work. Bluesky, with its relaxed and open atmosphere, feels just right.

She uploads the image, adds a short caption “Morning warmup sketch” and posts it. Then she scrolls through the feed. Within ten minutes, her sketch is already buried between text posts, links, and jokes. Other artists’ works disappear the same way, lost among constant chatter.

Minji opens her profile and taps on the Media tab. All her sketches are neatly organized there like a small gallery, yet she knows most followers rarely visit this section. They simply scroll through their timelines and move on.

### Minji’s Wish

I wish there were a space where my artwork could be seen visually without being lost in a text feed. A place where people could naturally find and appreciate my drawings.



## User Scenario / Viewers

### Junho Park

|            |                   |
|------------|-------------------|
| Age        | 25                |
| Occupation | Design Student    |
| Location   | Vancouver, Canada |



### Context: Morning commute, Vancouver

On a Thursday morning in Vancouver, Junho puts on his earphones and opens Bluesky while riding the bus to work. For fifteen quiet minutes before his coffee shop shift, he enjoys looking through sketches and doodles from the artists he follows. It is a small but meaningful part of his daily routine.

Bluesky feels like a light and creative space to him. The posts are casual and honest, filled with small moments of inspiration rather than polished perfection. But as he scrolls, most of his feed is filled with text, updates, and links. To find artwork, he has to visit each artist’s profile and open the Media tab one by one.

After a few minutes, he realizes he has gone through eight profiles and seen only a handful of images. As the bus approaches his stop, he feels a little disappointed. The time he spent scrolling did not match the inspiration he hoped to find.

Junho imagines how much easier it would be if all the images from the artists he follows could appear in one place. He locks his phone and thinks about a space that would show only images, simple and visual, free from distraction.

### Junho’s Wish

I want to see all the images from the artists I follow in one feed, without switching between profiles or scrolling through text. Not just finished works, but their everyday sketches and creative process.

# JOURNEY MAP

## Journey Map / Viewers



Junho Park

### START

1. Wants to begin the morning with a calm, visual feed in bed.
2. Opens the Bluesky app.
3. Thinks, "What kind of sketches will I see today?"
4. Starts scrolling through the feed.

Relaxed +5

“

What kind of sketches will I see today?

### BROWSE

5. Scrolls the home timeline filled with text posts.
6. Doesn't want to read text early in the morning, but it's tiring.
7. Wants to view only image posts but there is no filter.
8. Thinks, "It would be nice if I could see only images."

Tired +3

“

Too much text this morning..."

### NAVIGATE

9. Opens the first artist's profile.
10. Taps the Media tab to find images.
11. Checks the latest posts.
12. Goes back and repeats with the next artist.

Annoyed +2

“

"I have to open every profile again."

### REPEAT

13. Repeats the process several times.
14. Enjoys some images but starts losing patience.
15. The repetition feels tiring and inefficient.
16. Thinks, 'This is getting annoying.'

Bothered +1

“

"I like the art, but this is tiring."

### EXIT

17. Decides to stop browsing.
18. Closes the app.
19. Opens YouTube instead.
20. Thinks, "I'll just watch something."

Indifferent +0

“

"Maybe I'll just watch YouTube."



# JOURNEY MAP

## Journey Map / Viewers

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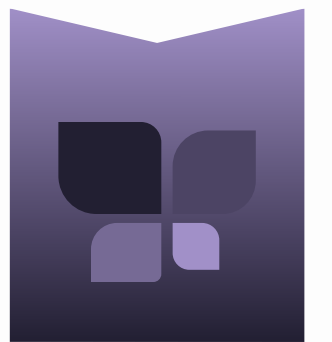
Junho Park

### Opportunities

- Image-only feed: Automatically filters text posts to create a clean, visual browsing experience, addressing the “too much text in the morning” pain point.
- Unified feed: Combines all images from followed artists into one continuous stream, removing the need to visit multiple profiles.
- Reduce repetition: Allows users to view all images through simple scrolling, cutting interaction steps from 20+ taps to just 3–4 per session.
- User retention: Keeps users engaged within the Bluesky ecosystem by resolving key navigation pain points and preventing drop-off to YouTube Shorts.

### Key Insights

- Core issue: Repetitive navigation leads to frustration and user drop-off. Users repeatedly visit three or more profiles to find images, causing annoyance (“This is getting tiring”) and eventual disengagement.
- Platform switching risk: The final behavior, “Maybe I’ll just watch YouTube” signals direct competition with external platforms. SkyFrame mitigates this by improving in-platform satisfaction.
- Emotional opportunity: The journey begins positive (Relaxed +5) but ends indifferent (0), revealing a clear intervention point during the Repeat stage.



# IA & USER FLOWS

## Sitemap

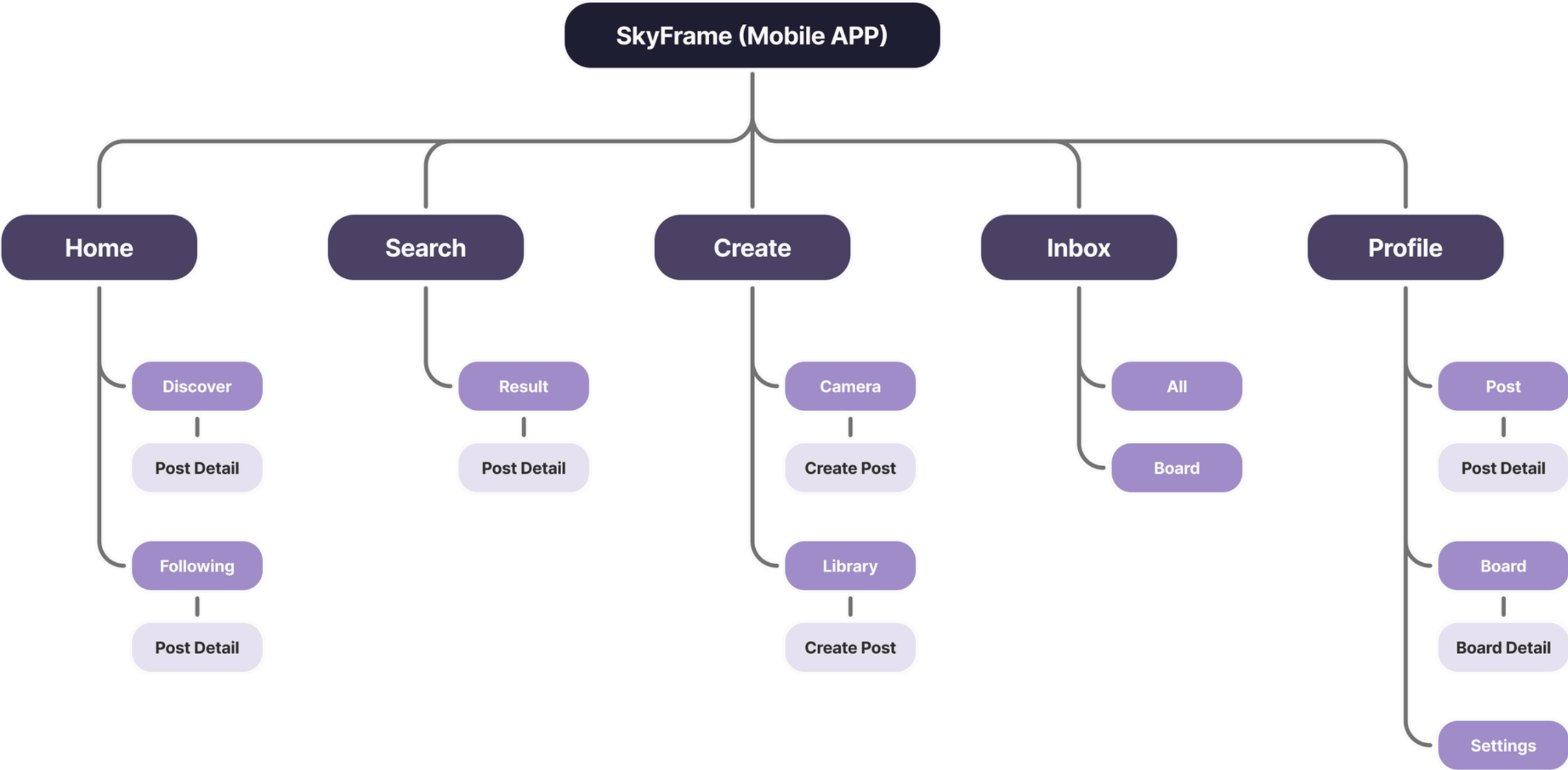
Legend

App Root

Main Tabs

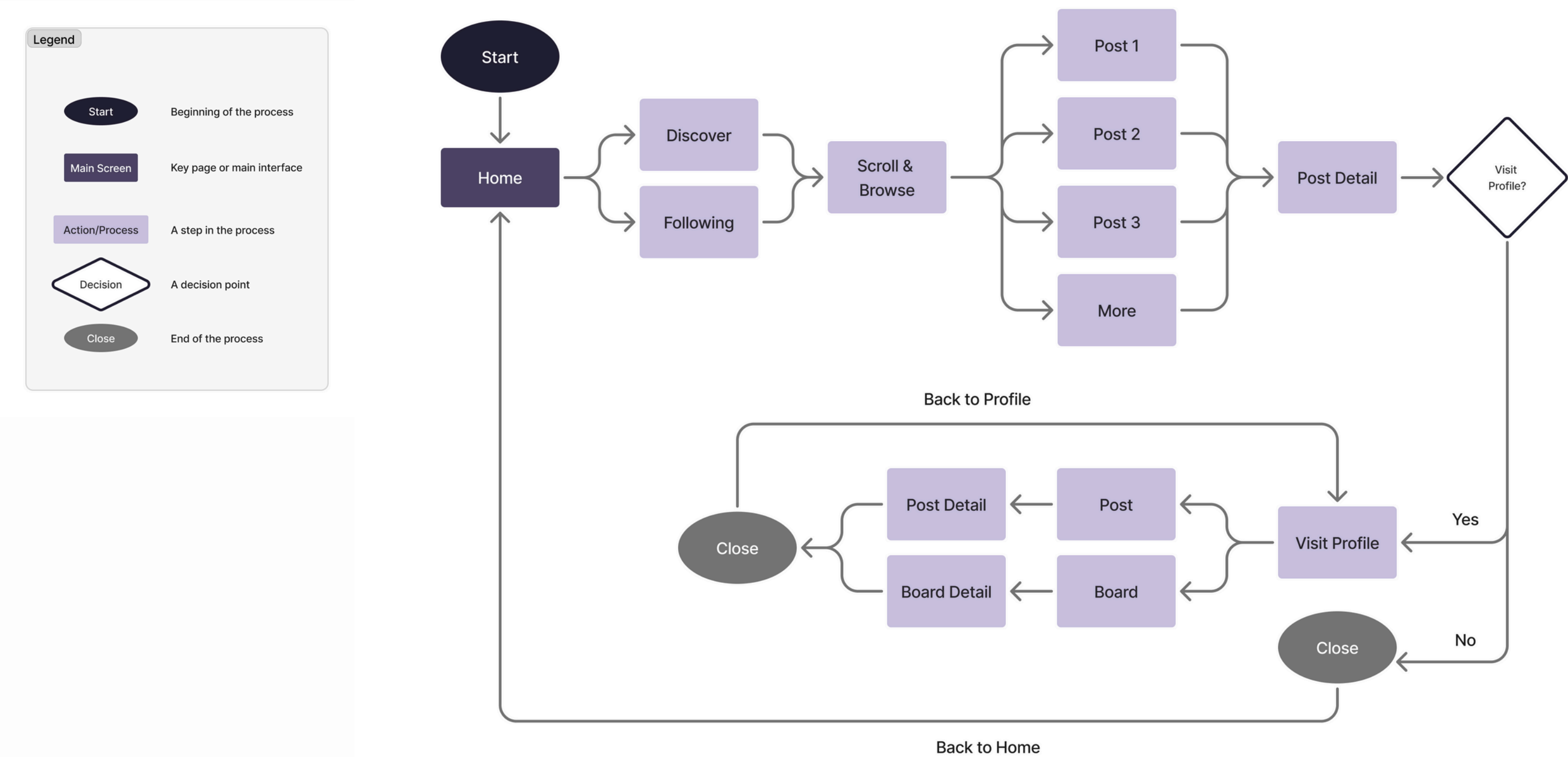
Sub-screens

Detail / End pages



# IA & USER FLOWS

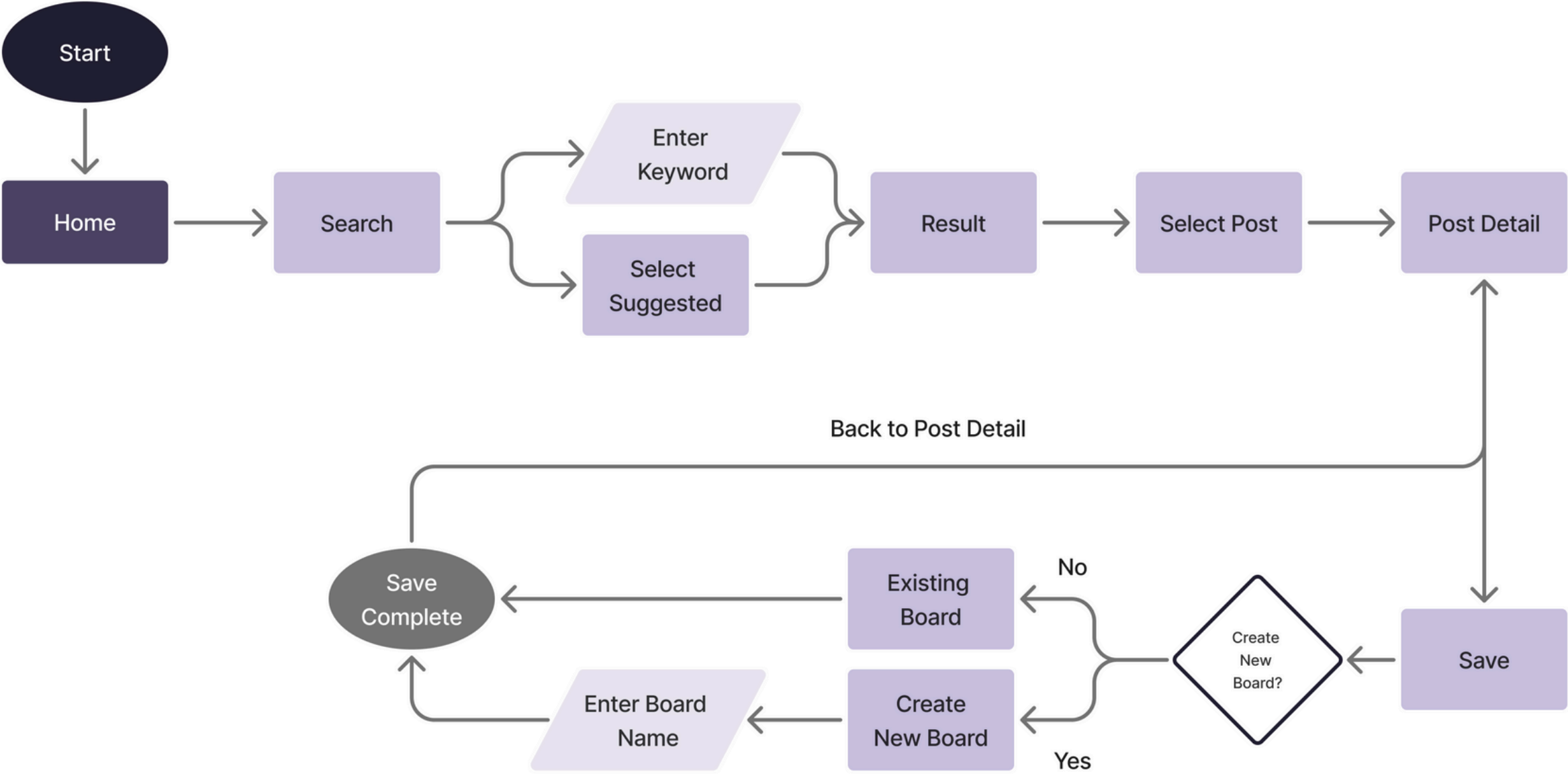
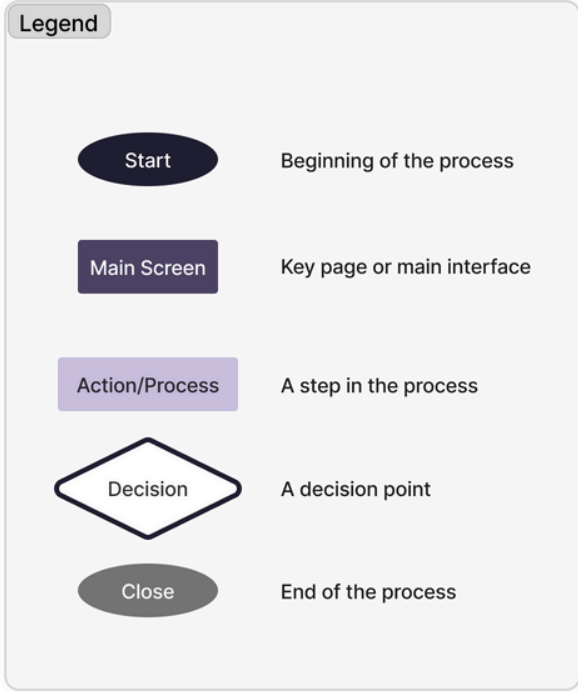
## Key Flow Chart / Flow 1. Browse & Visit





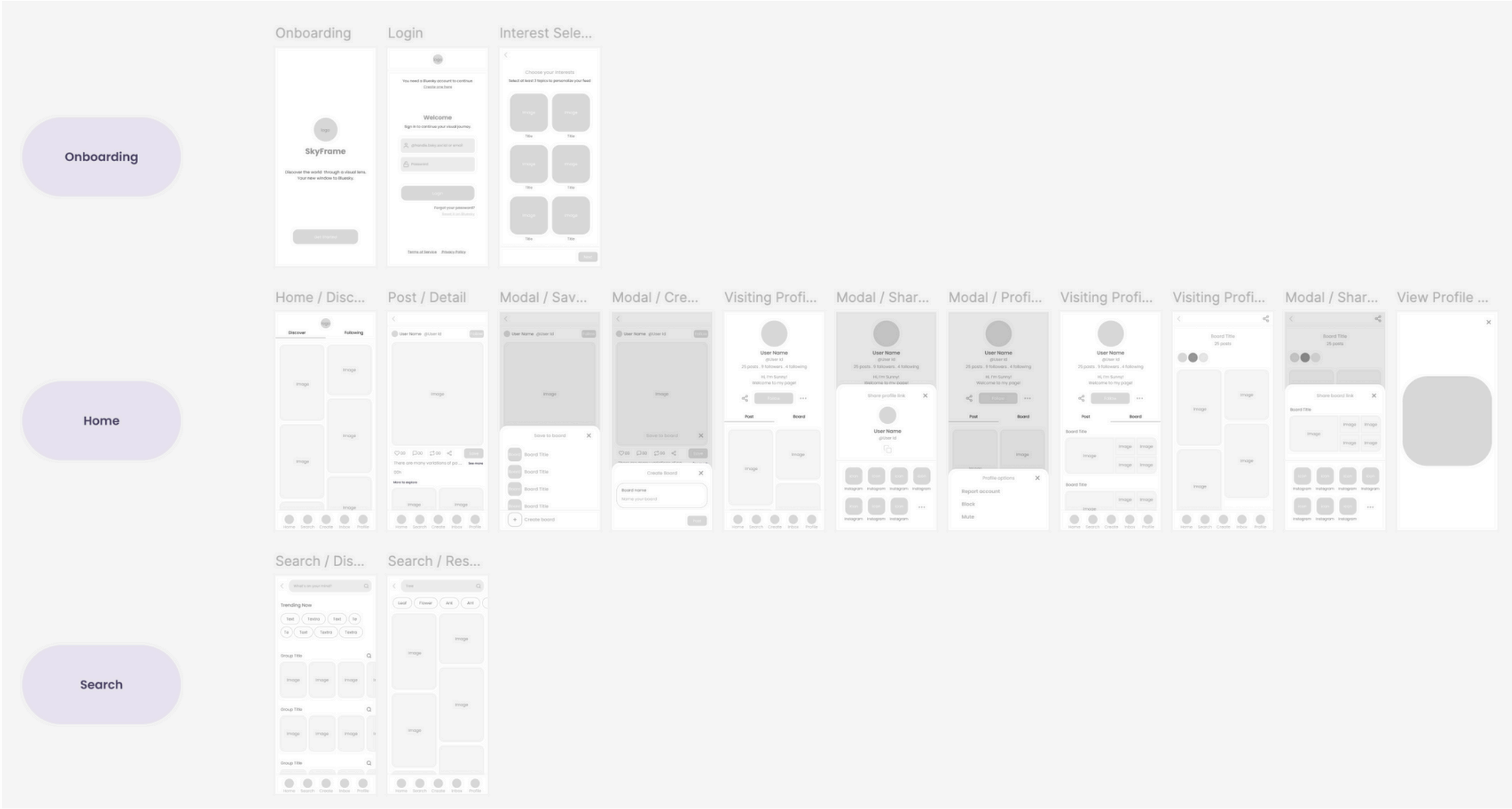
# IA & USER FLOWS

## Key Flow Chart / Flow 2. Search & Save



# WIREFRAMES

## Onboarding / Home / Search



[View All Wireframes](#)

# WIREFRAMES

## Create / Inbox / Profile



[View All Wireframes](#)

## Foundation

### Logo



- The name represents viewing Bluesky through a focused, visual frame.
- The icon transforms Bluesky's butterfly into a window frame, symbolizing how users discover image content through SkyFrame's curated lens.

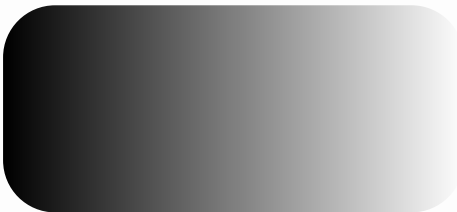
### Colors

#### Primary

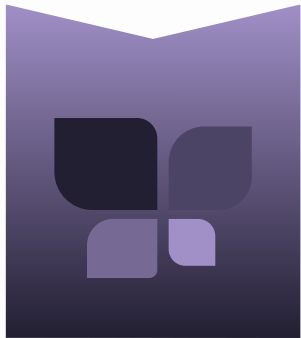


#4C4464 #766A95

#### Gray



- Purple creates a calm, comfortable browsing atmosphere while differentiating SkyFrame from other social platforms.
- The monochromatic gray palette keeps the interface minimal, ensuring user-generated images remain the focal point in this image-first experience.





## Foundation

### Typography

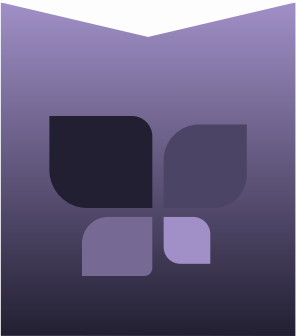
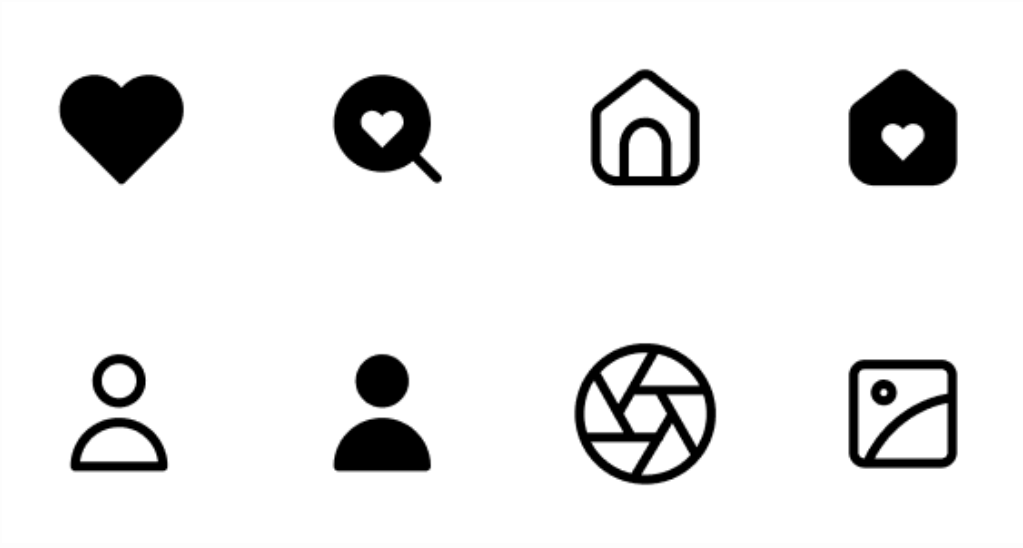
#### Poppins

- **Bold for Display**
- **SemiBold for H1, H2**
- **Medium for H3**
- **Regular for Body**

Clear hierarchy maintains readability across all content.

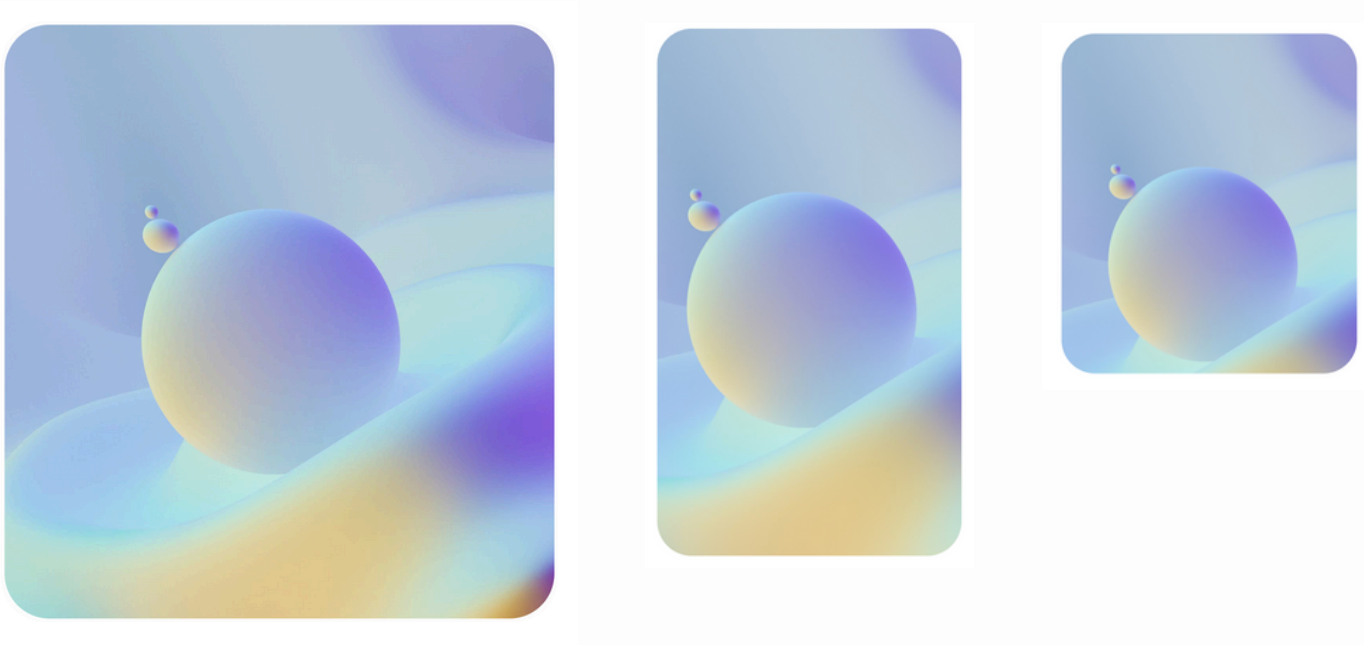
### Icons

#### Feather Icons+ Custom SVG



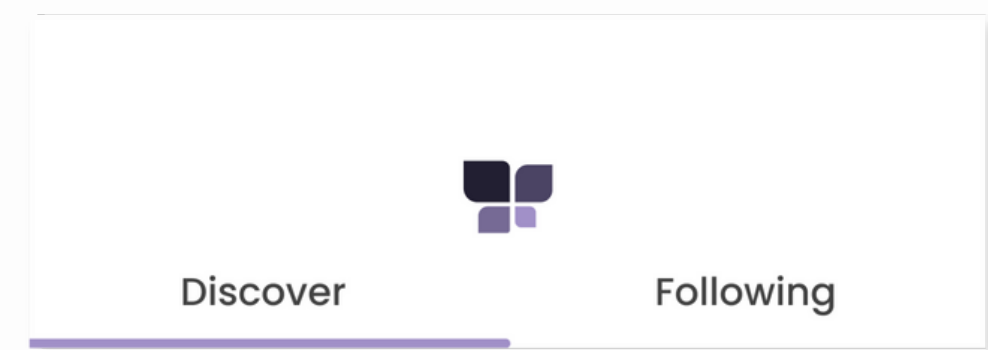
## Components

Card

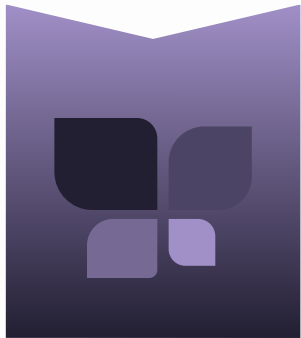
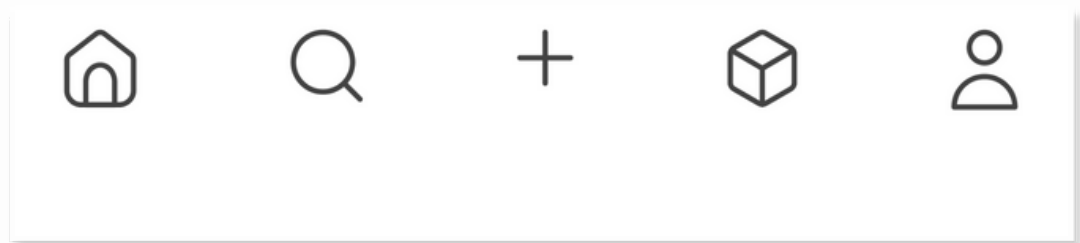


Navigation

Home Tab

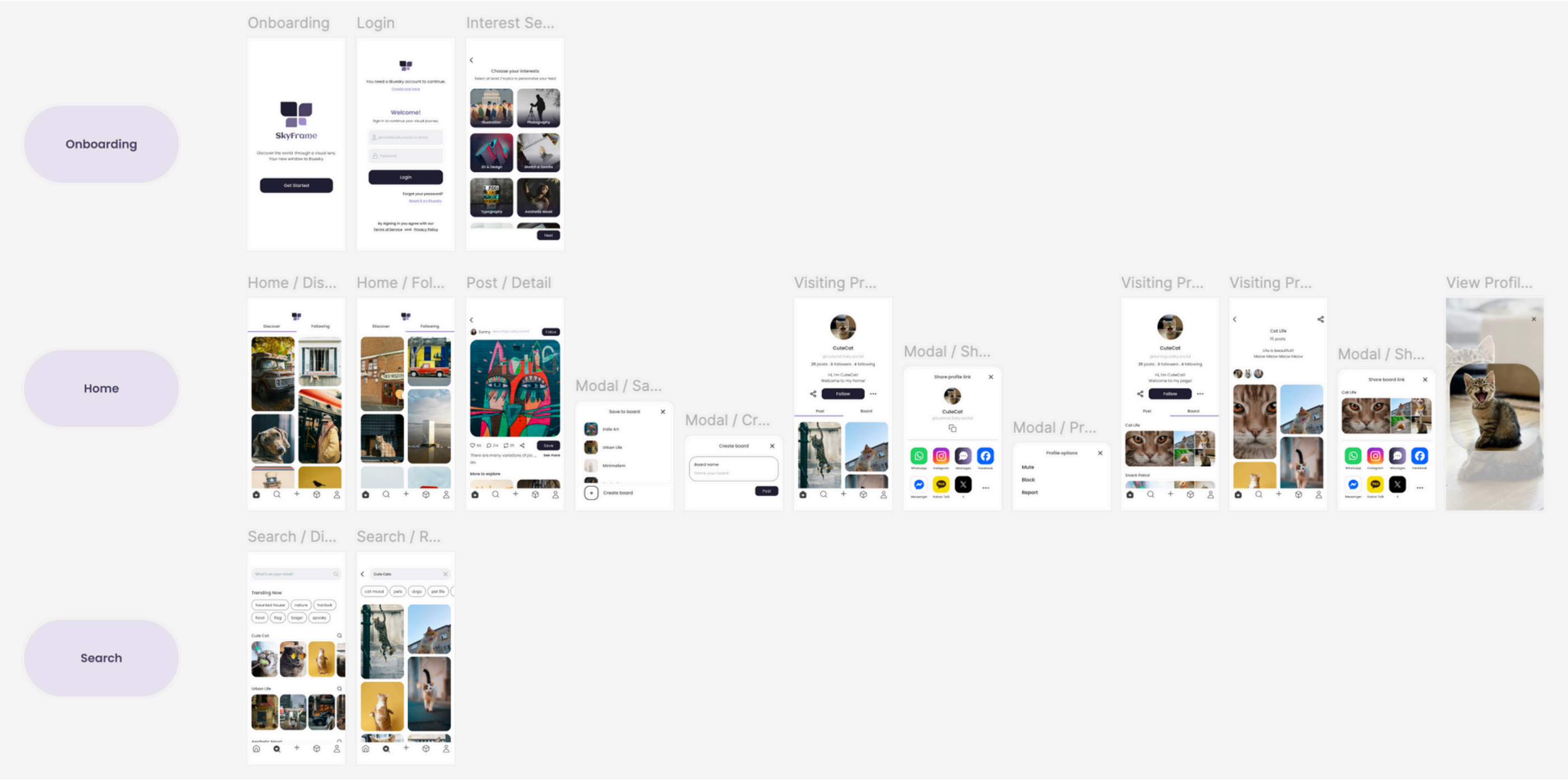


Bottom Navigation



# HIGH-FIDELITY MOCKUPS

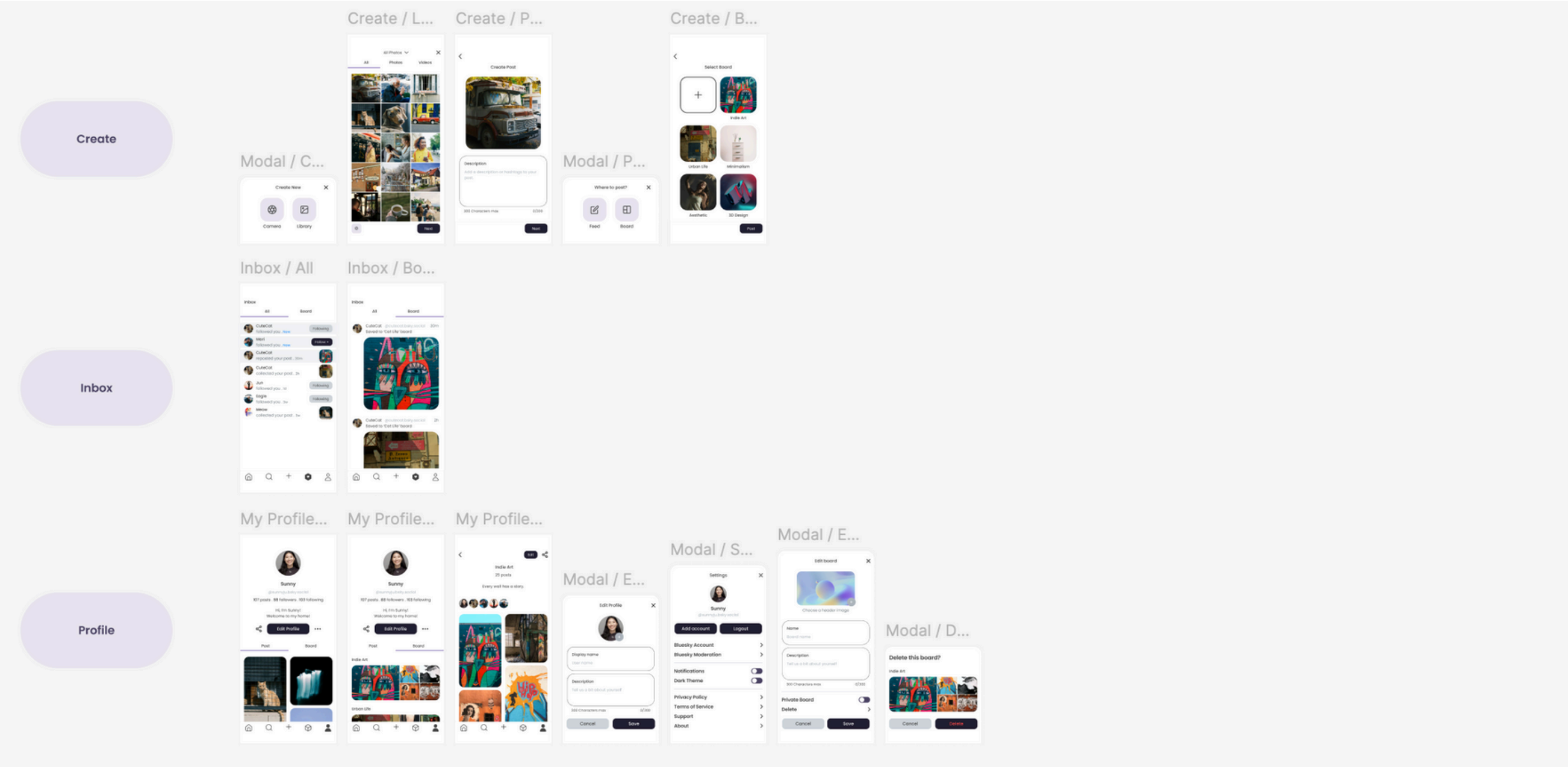
Onboarding / Home / Search



[View All Mockups](#)

# HIGH-FIDELITY MOCKUPS

Create / Inbox / Profile

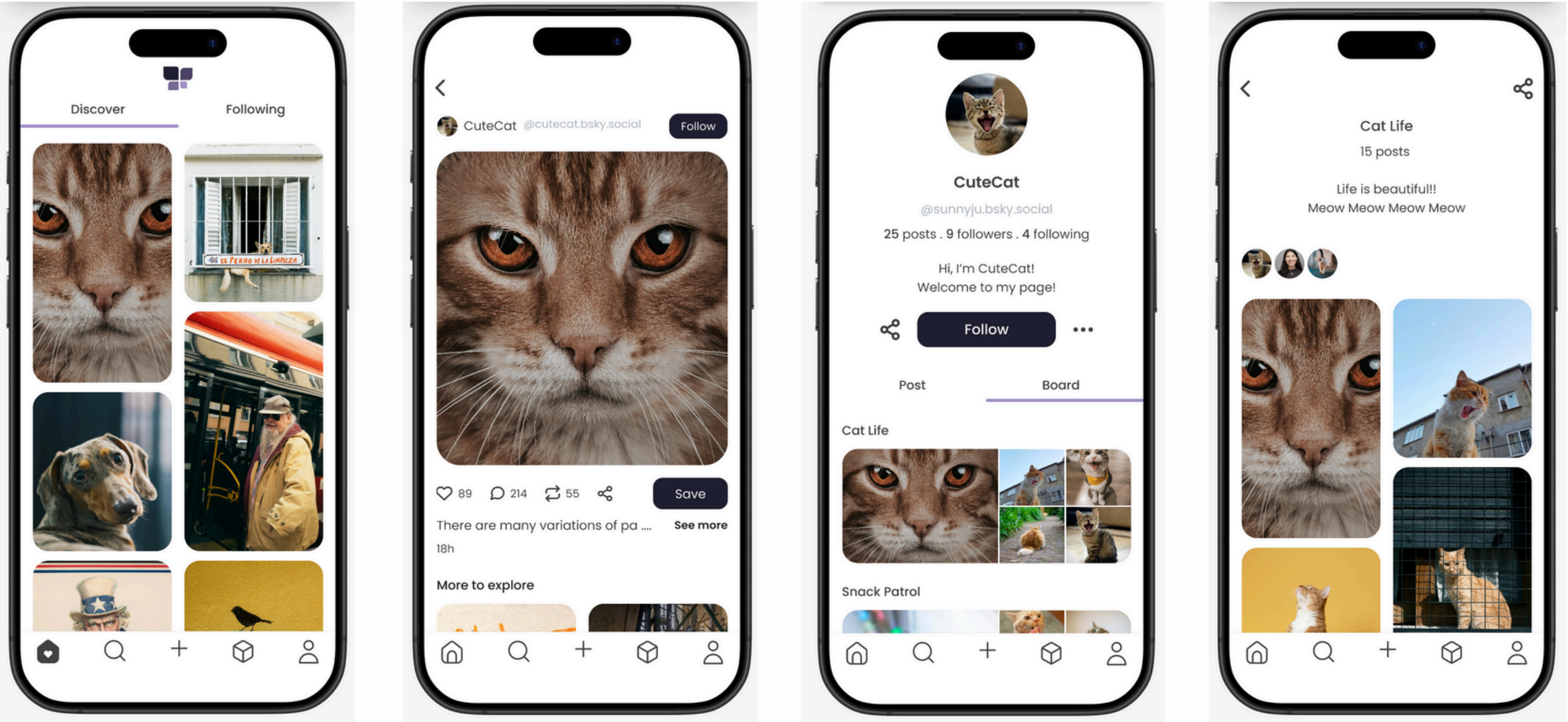


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# PROTOTYPE

## Flow 1. Browse & Visit



Home Tab



Post Detail



Visit Profile



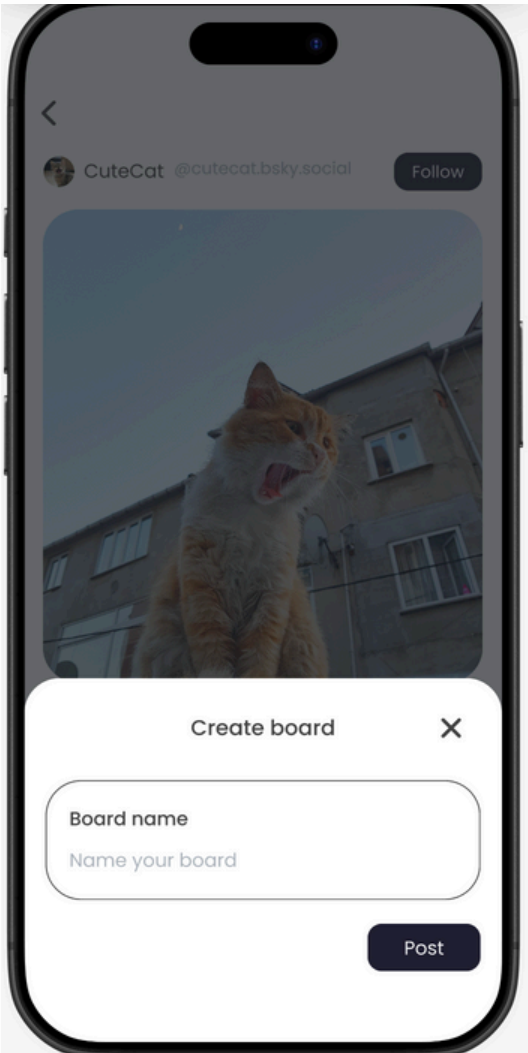
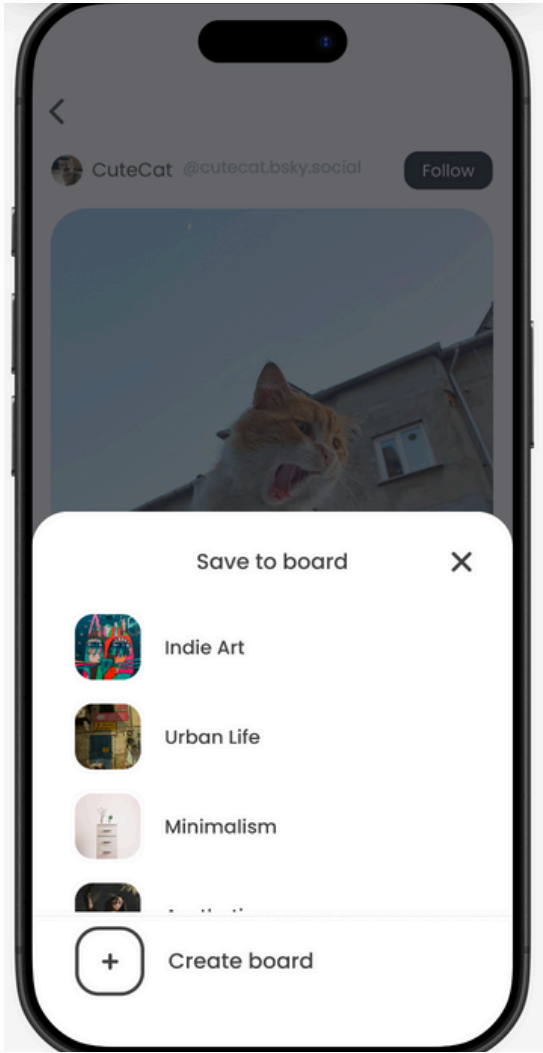
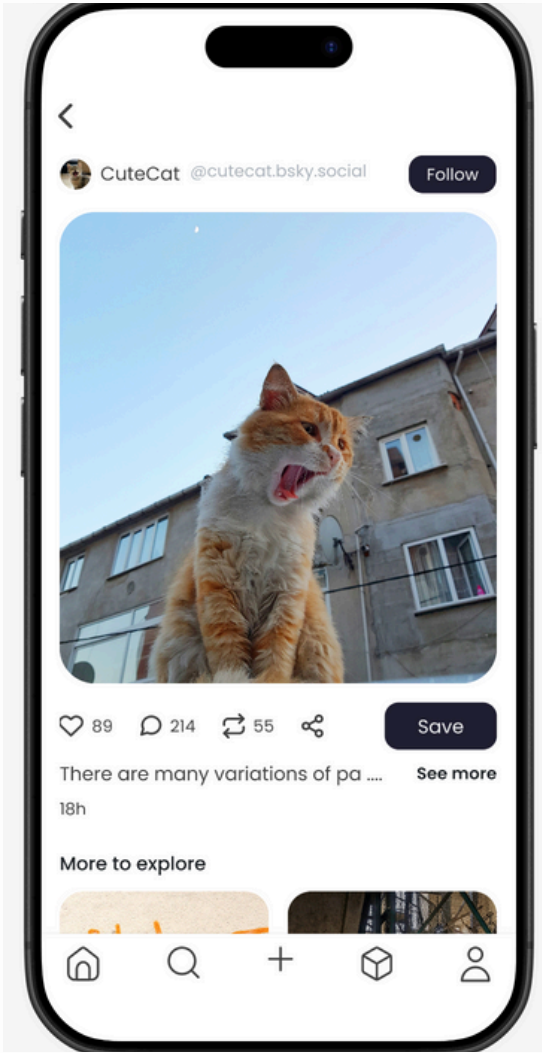
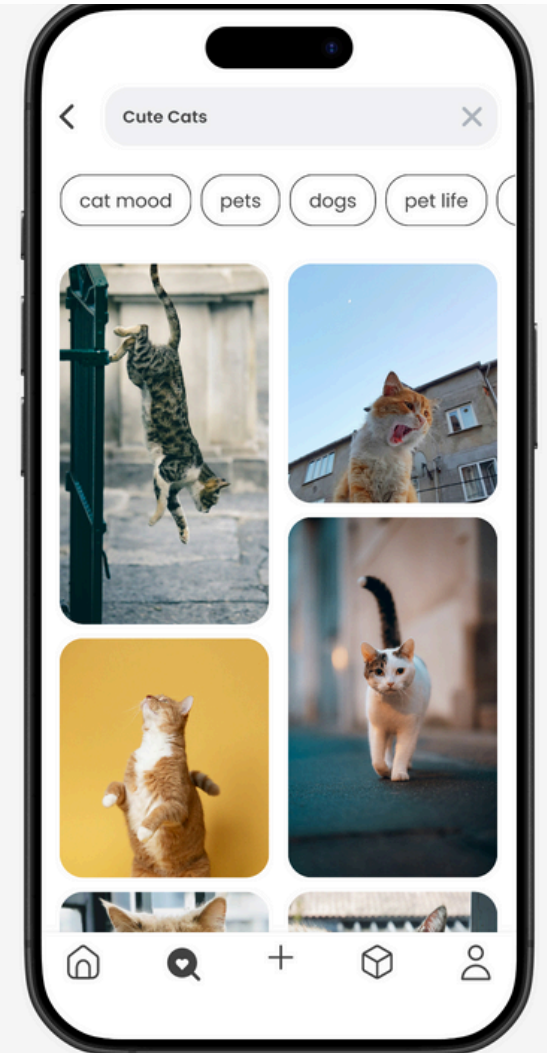
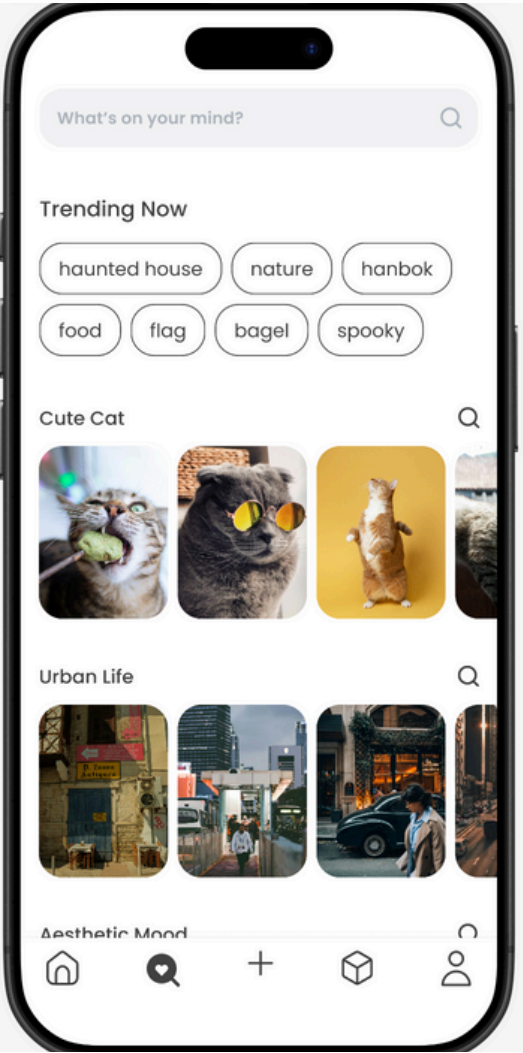
Board Detail

[View All Prototype](#)



# PROTOTYPE

## Flow 2. Search & Save



Search Tab



Search Result



Post Detail



Save to Board



Create New Board

[View All Prototype](#)